

Westhampton Public Library Board of Trustees Meeting

Date: 4.9.24

Time: 6:00pm

Community Room Westhampton Public Library

In-Person and Virtual Meeting

Present: Meaghan Schwelm, Angela Griefen, Jackie Brodeur, Deb Estelle, Via Zoom: Caralyn Whipple, Deb Smith

Absent: Anne Marie O'Reilly

1. Call To Order: 6:05pm
2. Minutes from Last meeting
3. Treasurer's Report: Accepted and Approved as submitted.

Account Balances:

Building - \$3,594.48

State Aid - \$4,695.76

Deferred Town Monies - \$35,327.93

Gifts - \$20,322.48

4. Director's Report: Accepted and Approved as submitted.

1. March Statistics

- 12 children's programs with 59 attending
- 21 adult programs with 106 attending
- 1 teen programs with 4 attending
- 0 general audience programs with 0 attending
- 82 volunteer hours
- Circulations 1,869 (in March 2023 - 1,978)
- Ebook circulations 483 (in March 2023 - 387)

2. PLA Conference - Some highlights were a presentation on programs/services for adults with developmental & intellectual disabilities entitled "We see you", an audiobook publishers lunch with author presentations, a presentation by a fellow MA librarian on "Debunking misinformation about trans identities and people", and "Unbannable: how libraries are ensuring access to banned books". There was a big emphasis on intellectual freedom and support for libraries/librarians amidst the current climate of challenges and bans. It was eye opening to meet and hear from librarians from other parts of the country. I would say that small, rural libraries were under represented in the program offerings, but I got something out of every program I attended and especially from talking to other librarians.

3. Discussion whether to hire Ashe Garden Design for a half or full day yard cleanup>
The cost would be \$400 for half day or \$800 for full day. A full day of clean up was approved.

5. Friend's Report: No report. Of note: Jo Martin has joined the Friends.
6. Old Business: Amendments to the Patron Behavior Policy: 1. Change to #7 replace "opiods" to "other drugs"; 2. In the final paragraph change "will ask" to "may ask" . A motion was made, and seconded, to accept these changes and approved unanimously approved.
7. New Business: Discussion of the benefits accorded to the two part-time employees and if they can work-from-home during bad weather; would it be possible to allow them PTO; and if it would be possible to increase the hours for Margaret to 12 hours per week. Meghan will explore town personnel policies with Doug.
8. Any other Business to come before the Trustees, not anticipated at the time of posting of this agenda: Angela Griefen will submit her name to continue as a Trustee.

Meeting Adjourned: 6:37pm
Next Meeting: May 14, 2024
Submitted By: Deb Estelle